England maternity inspections 2022 and 2023

README - revised 6 November 2026

Use the Excel in Background/outputs. All 179 inspection records retain the same three-tab layout and eight inspection columns. Notes now identify the inspection reason and assess its timing, alongside the existing date uncertainty. No dates, hospitals, trusts or addresses were changed in this reason review.

Excel tab	Contents
CQC national programme	131 records from the national maternity programme.
Other CQC visits	48 additional focused, concern-triggered or follow-up episodes.
Reports and sources	164 report-title/publication entries plus 24 research resources. Supporting date sources are attached to the relevant report entry.

Reading the dates

Inspection from / Inspection to are sortable Excel dates. Equal dates identify a reported single day. Different dates are the bounds of a reported period or separate visits. They do not establish attendance on every intervening day. Notes list separate dates, shared-site periods, source conflicts and any remaining uncertainty. Report published is the release date, not the visit date.

There are 112 records with a single preferred day, 66 with a period, and one with no confirmed maternity follow-up date. York and Scarborough now have dates for the initial inspection only; the later maternity revisit remains undated. A populated period is not an exact hospital-day assignment.

Folder contents

Background/outputs contains this README PDF and the current Excel. Background/raw holds the original CQC reports, NHS board papers, national audit correspondence and earlier substantive collection records. Downloaded CQC PDF names are listed in Reports and sources. Collection_evidence_records.xlsx retains detailed extraction and inclusion decisions, NMPA letter dates and legal examples. Earlier_UK_oversight_records.xlsx preserves the previous broader UK collection. CQC_location_history_extracts.pdf preserves the selected webpage entries in readable form. No programming is needed to open these files.

Literature remains separate and unchanged. Temporary previews, extracted text, JSON/CSV working files, old duplicate outputs and programming scripts have been removed from the project. Original source reports and substantive research records are retained.

What the date review established

Rochdale Infirmary - 11 August 2022

CQC assigns this day to the Rochdale entry, which describes maternity only. The multi-hospital PDF cover is broader. This is a site-specific CQC date; the day is not repeated in the PDF. Sources: CQC history and report pp. 278-279.

Royal Preston and Chorley - 3-4 July 2023

The 3 August 2023 NHS Board papers explicitly identify maternity inspections across both sites on these dates (PDF p. 33). They do not allocate an individual day to each hospital. The CQC May/June headings concern other services.

Royal Victoria Infirmary - 25-27 July 2023

The Maternity Service Update to the 23 May 2024 NHS Board explicitly records this inspection period (PDF p. 150). The CQC cover includes other June-September work.

York and Scarborough - 11-13 October 2022, initial visits

The Trust CQC Inspection Update for the 22 November 2022 scrutiny meeting identifies this initial period across both sites (PDF p. 3). Individual site/maternity days and the later revisit day are not specified.

Birmingham Heartlands - Still unconfirmed

The report lists several visits across services. PDF p. 154 describes equipment checks through 13 June and a 21 June risk assessment as after the visit. A 13 June visit is plausible, but inferred. The Excel date cells remain blank.

Bedford and Luton - 2-3 August 2022

CQC report p. 3 separates the core-service visits, including maternity, from the 20-21 September trust well-led work. The date cells now exclude September. Individual site days are not assigned.

Separate visits preserved

Notes now list King's College Hospital's 1, 2 and 11 August 2022 visits; Hull's 15 March, 24 and 25 April 2023 visits; and Royal Derby's 15, 16, 22 and 23 August 2023 dates. Southend's location-heading/cover conflict remains explicitly flagged. The original range bounds for these four records are retained.

Research context and source use

CQC programme

The national programme inspected 131 locations across 92 NHS trusts between August 2022 and December 2023, focusing on safe and well-led care. The national synthesis, Maternity services 2022 to 2024, was published on 19 September 2024. Its title includes the reporting year. The 48 additional episodes are a separately collected public-source extension, not a certified census of every English maternity visit.

CQC national maternity review

Inspection reason flags

The documented reasons identify 128 routine programme records with no separate trigger stated, 27 concern-triggered records, 19 follow-ups to earlier concerns, 3 mixed cases and 2 unclear cases. Mixed cases are Rochdale (programme within risk-based trust selection), Hull and Royal Derby (programme plus later safety recheck, whose scheduling basis is unclear). The initial trigger is unclear for King's College Hospital and Princess Royal University Hospital. These are reason classifications, not findings that timing is exogenous. The generic CQC heading "routine inspection" is overridden where the narrative explicitly describes concerns.

Could timing provide exogenous variation?

The 128 routine programme records are potential candidates for an inspection-timing design. The programme targeted services with older inspections. Eligibility was targeted, and the reports do not establish random or as-if-random ordering of visits. Obtain scheduling and notification records, assess whether recent outcomes or complaints affected the order, and examine pre-trends within a comparable eligible cohort. A lack of pre-trends alone does not prove exogeneity. Unannounced describes notice, not random assignment.

Concern-led visits and follow-ups respond to earlier quality, complaints, enforcement or provider applications. Their dates should not be used as exogenous quality shocks without a separate source of quasi-random timing. Keep them out of the primary scheduling-based design, or analyse them separately. Separate initial programme visits from later safety rechecks; the combined Hull/Derby periods should not be assumed to be single exogenous shocks. Allow for anticipation, shared trust-level actions and spillovers between hospitals.

An inspection can change public information, anxiety and hospital choice directly. For a maternal mental health outcome, using inspection timing as an instrument for clinical quality therefore requires a separate exclusion argument and a demonstrated quality first stage. Estimating the total effect of inspection is a different claim from identifying the effect of care quality alone.

Evidence and other resources

Flags use the stated inspection reason in the PDF or a dated CQC release, with references in Notes and Reports and sources. Findings or enforcement issued after a visit are not treated as its trigger. The existing source catalogue also covers NMPA audit letters, NHS Resolution claims, legal cases, improvement programmes, outcome sources and historical trust/site linkage.

CQC programme methodology and eligibility

Remaining limitations

The Rochdale day rests on the CQC site entry. Royal Preston/Chorley and Bedford/Luton retain shared-site periods. York/Scarborough retain only their initial visit period and have an undated later revisit. Heartlands remains without a confirmed maternity follow-up day. Some other rows retain shared periods or cover-heading conflicts, as stated in Notes. Later CQC addresses remain flagged where the historical address was not established. Trust names follow the inspection report. CQC location identifiers should not automatically be treated as ODS codes.

No institutional requests have been sent. Source collection was originally completed on 31 October-1 November 2026. This focused date review was completed on 6 November 2026.